

Transferable Skills Checklist

Transferable skills are skills in which people learn through education, professional experiences, and interpersonal encounters. These skills are valued by employers across all disciplines and are often forgotten or left out of the resume. Use this checklist to start thinking about some of the skills you learned and utilized. They can then be incorporated with the keyword or action verbs to highlight skills that will be useful in any setting, regardless of the relevance to the field.

Communication Skills

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| ☒ speaking effectively | ☒ providing appropriate feedback |
| ☒ writing clearly and concisely | ☒ negotiating |
| ☒ listening attentively and objectively | ☒ perceiving nonverbal messages |
| ☒ expressing ideas | ☒ persuading |
| ☒ facilitating group discussion | ☒ reporting information |
| ☒ interviewing | ☒ describing feelings |
| ☒ editing | ☒ public speaking |
| ☒ responding appropriately to +/- feedback | ☒ using various styles of written communication |
| ☒ using various media to present ideas imaginatively | ☒ conveying a positive self image to others |

Research/Planning/Investigation

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| ☒ forecasting/predicting | ☒ analyzing |
| ☒ creating ideas | ☒ developing evaluation strategies |
| ☒ identifying problems | ☒ testing validity of data |
| ☒ imagining alternatives | ☒ designing an experiment or model |
| ☒ identifying resources | ☒ formulating questions |
| ☒ gathering information | ☒ making conclusions |
| ☒ solving problems | ☒ conceptualizing |
| ☒ setting goals | ☒ observing and discovering |
| ☒ extracting important information | ☒ defining needs |

Human Relations/Interpersonal

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| ☒ developing rapport | ☒ being patient |
| ☒ being sensitive | ☒ interacting effectively with peers, superiors, and subordinates |
| ☒ listening | ☒ persuading others |
| ☒ conveying feelings | ☒ being willing to take risks |
| ☒ providing support for others | ☒ teaching/instructing others |
| ☒ motivating | ☒ demonstrating effective social behavior |
| ☒ sharing credit | ☒ perceiving feelings and situations |
| ☒ helping others | ☒ delegating with respect |
| ☒ counseling | ☒ working with diversity or multi-cultural issues |
| ☒ cooperating | ☒ keeping a group "on track" |

Work Survival

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| ☒ implementing decisions | ☒ meeting goals |
| ☒ cooperation | ☒ enlisting help |
| ☒ enforcing policies | ☒ accepting responsibility |
| ☒ being punctual | ☒ setting and meeting deadlines |
| ☒ managing time and stress | ☒ organizing |
| ☒ attending to detail | ☒ making decisions |
| ☒ working effectively under pressure | ☒ seeking opportunities for professional development |
| ☒ taking initiative in job-related duties | ☒ evaluating personal and professional strengths and weakness |
| ☒ discerning appropriate behaviors for the workplace | |

Organization/Management/Leadership/Decision Making

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| ☐ initiating new ideas and tasks | ☐ managing groups |
| ☒ handling details | ☒ delegating responsibility |
| ☒ coordinating tasks | ☒ teaching/instructing |
| ☒ coaching/mentoring | ☒ promoting change |
| ☐ counseling | ☐ selling ideas or products |
| ☐ managing conflict | ☒ making decisions with others |
| ☐ motivating and leading people | ☒ analyzing tasks |
| ☒ organizing people/tasks to achieve a specific goal | ☐ identifying people who can contribute to solutions of problems or tasks |
| ☒ following up with others to evaluate progress | ☒ facilitating brainstorming activities |
| ☒ conducting meetings | ☐ developing goals for an organization |
| ☒ giving praise and credit to others for a job well done | ☒ prioritizing tasks |
| ☒ solving problems/mediating | ☐ encouraging and inspiring |
| ☒ taking risks | ☒ negotiating agreements |
| ☒ implementing sound decisions | ☒ taking responsibility for decisions |

Financial Management

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| ☐ developing a budget accurately estimating expenses and income | ☒ ensuring timeliness of payments |
| ☒ keeping accurate and complete financial records | ☐ fundraising |
| ☐ accounting | ☒ calculating |
| ☒ assessing | ☒ projecting/forecasting |
| ☐ investing | |

Critical Thinking/Problem Solving

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| ☒ anticipating problems before they occur | ☐ involving group members to evaluate solutions |
| ☒ defining problems and identifying possible causes | ☒ developing plans to implement solutions |
| ☒ identifying possible solutions and selecting the most appropriate ones | ☒ multi-tasking |
| ☒ creating innovative solutions to complex problems | ☒ identifying a general principle that explains interrelated experience |

To start brainstorming about relating your transferable skills to your previous experiences use this worksheet. Fill out the five most important skills, combined with where you learned them, and examples of you implementing the skills.

Skill**Example**

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| 1. <u>Forecasting/predicting</u> | <u>I estimate the viability of a research question before pursuing it.</u> |
| 2. <u>Observing and discovering</u> | <u>I actively observe and take stock of any new environment or research area.</u> |
| 3. <u>Providing support for others</u> | <u>I step in to help teammates, especially under tight deadlines.</u> |
| 4. <u>Handling details</u> | <u>I keep work organized, readable, and reproducible.</u> |
| 5. <u>Defining problems and identifying possible causes</u> | <u>I instinctively seek root causes to prevent recurring issues.</u> |

Adapted from Missouri State Career Center